

Interrogation Record: Gauntlet of Sorrowfell

[The record begins beneath a black seal. The chamber is unlit except for a narrow lamp. The interrogator's face is omitted from the account, as is the prisoner's name. Between them rests a covered object.]

INTERROGATOR: State the designation of the relic.

SUBJECT: You know it already.

INTERROGATOR: State it.

SUBJECT: Gauntlet of Sorrowfell.

[A pause. Cloth shifts over metal, though no hand is seen touching it.]

INTERROGATOR: What is it?

SUBJECT: Regalia.

INTERROGATOR: That is not an answer.

SUBJECT: It is the answer given by every court that still possesses a chair worth stealing. Gauntlet of Sorrowfell is regalia. Not a tool. Not a trophy. Not a weapon, unless the wearer has the wit to make authority into one.

INTERROGATOR: Describe its appearance.

SUBJECT: Its visual identity is that of regalia bearing the name Gauntlet of Sorrowfell.

INTERROGATOR: You repeat the record.

SUBJECT: The record repeats what cannot be improved.

[The interrogator removes the covering. The account does not describe the metal, its ornament, or the hand-shaped darkness within it.]

INTERROGATOR: What does it demand?

SUBJECT: Attunement.

INTERROGATOR: At what cost?

SUBJECT: The attunement cost is 12.

INTERROGATOR: Twelve what?

SUBJECT: The record gives no further measure. Ask it for another answer, and it will give you silence. Ask the silence long enough, and you will begin supplying the answer yourself.

INTERROGATOR: Has it been worn?

SUBJECT: That question presumes too much.

INTERROGATOR: Has it been forged?

SUBJECT: The forging date is not recorded in the supplied facts.

INTERROGATOR: You hide behind phrasing.

SUBJECT: Phrasing is what remains when testimony is burned.

[The lamp gutters. The covered object appears, for one breath, to be crowned rather than armored.]

INTERROGATOR: What atmosphere does Gauntlet of Sorrowfell carry?

SUBJECT: Sorrow. Grim authority.

INTERROGATOR: Whose sorrow?

SUBJECT: No owner is named in this record.

INTERROGATOR: Whose authority?

SUBJECT: No bearer is named in this record.

INTERROGATOR: Then why fear it?

SUBJECT: Fear does not require a bearer. A sealed decree can empty a hall. A vacant throne can command kneeling. Gauntlet of Sorrowfell carries an atmosphere of sorrow and grim authority. That is sufficient.

[Here the subject ceased speaking. The interrogator continued for an unrecorded interval. No further answers were entered.]

FINAL ENTRY: Gauntlet of Sorrowfell remains classified as regalia. Attunement cost: 12. Forging date: not recorded in the supplied facts.